BONUS · NEUROKIDS

Gratitude Journal

Help your child cultivate thankfulness, positivity, and emotional well-being

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INTRODUCTION

What Is Gratitude?

Understanding thankfulness and why it matters for young minds

> *Gratitude means noticing and appreciating the good things in your life — big and small!*

When you practice gratitude, you train your brain to look for the positive things around you. It might be a sunny day, a hug from someone you love, or your favorite meal for dinner. The more you notice these things, the happier and more connected you feel.

Why Gratitude Matters for Kids

Research shows that children who practice gratitude regularly tend to feel happier, sleep better, get along better with friends, feel more positive about school, and show more kindness to others. Even a few minutes each day can make a big difference!

How to Use This Journal

1. **Pick a quiet time each day** — Before bed or after school works great. Find a calm moment when you can think without distractions.
2. **Think about your day** — What happened today? What made you smile? Who was kind to you? What did you enjoy?
3. **Write or draw** — Fill in each day's page. There are no wrong answers! Even small things count, like a good snack or a funny joke.
4. **Share with someone you love** — Talk about what you wrote with a parent, sibling, or friend. Sharing gratitude makes it even more powerful!

Dear Parent or Guardian

This journal is designed to be a gentle daily habit. You do not need to force it — even two or three entries per week will build the gratitude muscle over time. Sit with your child, share your own grateful moments, and keep the conversation light and positive. If your child struggles to think of something, try asking: “What was the best part of your day?” or “Who helped you today?” The goal is not perfection — it is simply noticing the good.

Before You Start

- [ ] Find a pencil, pen, or crayons you enjoy writing with
- [ ] Choose a time of day that works for you (morning or evening)
- [ ] Find a comfortable, quiet spot
- [ ] Take three deep breaths to relax
- [ ] Remember: every answer is a good answer!

DAY 1: FAMILY

Think about the people in your family who love you. Who makes you laugh? Who helps you when things are hard? Who do you love spending time with? Family can include anyone who feels like family to you.

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw a picture of a happy moment from your day.

DAY 2: FRIENDS

Think about your friends and what makes them special. Who do you like playing with? What is your favorite thing to do together? What makes a good friend? How have your friends been kind to you?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw a picture of a happy moment from your day.

DAY 3: NATURE

Think about the beautiful things you see outside. What is your favorite thing about nature? Have you seen any animals, flowers, or trees lately? What does your favorite season look like? What sounds do you hear outside?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw a picture of something beautiful you saw in nature.

DAY 4: SCHOOL

Think about something you learned or enjoyed at school. What is your favorite subject? Who is a teacher or classmate you appreciate? What is something new you learned recently? What do you look forward to at school?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw your favorite part of the school day.

DAY 5: MY BODY

Think about all the amazing things your body can do. Can you run, jump, dance, or swim? What is your favorite way to move? What do your eyes, ears, and hands help you do every day? What is something your body did today that you are thankful for?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw yourself doing your favorite activity.

DAY 6: FOOD

Think about your favorite foods and the people who make them. What is your favorite meal? Who cooks for you? What is a special treat you love? What food makes you feel warm and happy inside?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw your favorite food or meal.

DAY 7: HOME

Think about your home and what makes it cozy and safe. What is your favorite room or spot in your home? What do you love about your bed? What makes your home feel like home? What sounds, smells, or feelings do you notice at home?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw your favorite spot in your home.

DAY 8: ADVENTURES

Think about a fun trip, outing, or adventure you had. Where did you go? Who was with you? What was the most exciting part? Would you go back again? Even a walk around the block can be an adventure!

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw an adventure you had or one you dream about.

DAY 9: KINDNESS

Think about a time someone was kind to you. What did they do? How did it make you feel? Have you been kind to someone recently? What is one kind thing you could do tomorrow?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw a moment when someone was kind to you.

DAY 10: LEARNING

Think about something new you learned recently. What was it? Who taught you? Was it easy or hard? How did it feel to learn something new? What do you want to learn next?

Date:

---

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw something new you learned.

DAY 11: PETS & ANIMALS

Think about animals you love — real or imaginary! Do you have a pet? What is your favorite animal? What do animals do that makes you happy? If you could have any animal as a pet, what would it be?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw your favorite animal or pet.

DAY 12: SEASONS

Think about your favorite things about this season. What does the weather feel like? What do you see outside? What activities do you enjoy in this season? What foods or holidays go with this time of year?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw your favorite thing about the current season.

DAY 13: MUSIC & ART

Think about songs, art, or creativity that make you happy. What is your favorite song? Do you like to draw, paint, dance, or play music? What colors make you feel happy? When do you feel most creative?

Date:

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3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to create something colorful and creative!

DAY 14: BOOKS & STORIES

Think about a book or story that you love. What is your favorite book? Who is your favorite character? Why do you like that story? What is a story you would like to write yourself?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw a scene from your favorite book or story.

DAY 15: MY FUTURE

Think about exciting things you want to do when you grow up. What do you dream about becoming? Where would you like to travel? What skill would you like to learn? What kind of person do you want to be?

Date:

3 THINGS I AM GRATEFUL FOR TODAY

1.

2.

3.

SOMEONE WHO MADE ME SMILE TODAY

ONE KIND THING I DID TODAY

Draw something that made you happy today

Use this space to draw what you want to be or do when you grow up.

ACTIVITY

Gratitude Jar

Cut out these slips, write something you are grateful for on each one, and collect them in a jar

When you are having a tough day, reach into your Gratitude Jar, pull out a slip, and read it. You will be reminded of all the wonderful things in your life!

How It Works

1. Cut out each slip along the dotted lines. 2. Write something you are grateful for on the blank line. 3. Fold each slip in half. 4. Drop it into a jar, box, or bag. 5. Keep adding slips whenever you think of something new!

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

I am grateful for:

ACTIVITY

My Gratitude Month

Check off each day you practiced gratitude this month

> *Try to practice gratitude every single day! Put a checkmark in the box for each day you write down something you are thankful for.*

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

DAYS I PRACTICED GRATITUDE THIS MONTH

Write your total here: ___ out of 31 days

Challenge

Can you fill every single box this month? Even on tough days, there is always something small to be grateful for — like a glass of cold water, a warm blanket, or the sound of birds in the morning.

ACTIVITY

Gratitude Alphabet Challenge

Can you think of something you are grateful for that starts with every letter of the alphabet?

> *This is a fun challenge! For each letter, write one thing you are grateful for that starts with that letter. Example: A — Apples.*

A —

B —

C —

D —

E —

F —

G —

H —

I —

J —

N —

O —

P —

Q —

R —

S —

T —

U —

V —

W —

K —

L —

M —

X —

Y —

Z —

ACTIVITY

Thank-You Card Templates

Cut out these cards, fill them in, and give them to people you appreciate

One of the best ways to practice gratitude is to tell people you are thankful for them. Cut out these cards, fill in the blanks, and give them to someone special!

Thank You!

Dear

I want to thank you for

It made me feel

From:

Thank You!

Dear

I want to thank you for

It made me feel

From:

Thank You!

Dear

I want to thank you for

It made me feel

From:

Thank You!

Dear

I want to thank you for

It made me feel

From:

ACTIVITY

My Gratitude Tree

Fill each leaf with something you are grateful for and watch your tree grow

This is your Gratitude Tree! Write or draw something you are grateful for on each leaf. As you think of more things, add more leaves. Watch how full and beautiful your tree becomes!

Instructions

Write one thing you are thankful for in each leaf below. Try to fill every leaf! You can also color the leaves green, yellow, orange, or red — like a tree in autumn.

LEAF 1

LEAF 2

LEAF 3

LEAF 4

LEAF 5

LEAF 6

LEAF 7

LEAF 8

LEAF 9

LEAF 10

LEAF 11

LEAF 12

Next Step

You have completed 15 days of gratitude practice — that is amazing! Keep the habit going by starting again from Day 1, or create your own gratitude pages in a blank notebook. Open the NeuroKids main guide and pick your first weekly activity plan to keep the learning going!